



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Classical School
School Website: <https://trinityclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinity Classical School (Mt. Airy, GA 30563) presents a robust Classical Christian program that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements framework for classical education. Public materials from the school consistently emphasize a Christ-centered, covenantal, virtue- and wisdom-focused aims, grounded in Christian theology and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The curriculum explicitly incorporates traditional classical structures (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; senior capstone), a historically informed and integrated approach to content, and memory-based pedagogy (Narration, Copywork, Dictation, Composer Study, Nature Study). Faculty are portrayed as living witnesses to virtue and faith, and parents are positioned as covenantal partners in education. Taken together, the school scores CLASSICAL across all six categories.

Key highlights: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: The Word of God and Christ-centered formation are foundational, with covenantal language governing admissions and curriculum; theology is foregrounded in mission and vision statements. - Purpose and Goal: Education is framed as formation toward virtue and wisdom, anchored in truth and divine order rather than purely vocational outcomes; the mission explicitly centers glorifying God and forming the whole person. - Curriculum: Clear classical structure (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin; senior capstone) plus exposure to living books via Veritas Press Omnibus in some courses; robust lower-school memory-and-nature-based practices. - Pedagogy: A mix of contemplative/memory-based practices in the early years (Narration, Copywork, Dictation; nature study) and rhetoric-oriented work in the upper grades, with opportunities for reasoned discourse and public speaking. - Faculty: Public statements position faculty as both professional educators and virtuous exemplars, the "living curriculum," and "mentors" who model Christian virtue. - Parents & Community: Strong emphasis on partnership with Christian families, covenantal commitments, and parental involvement as co-educators within a Christ-centered framework.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Mission statements foreground covenant with Christian parents and the Christian Classical model, with the Word of God as the foundation and Christ-centered aims.
- Admissions policy requires faith in Christ and church involvement, tying school culture to a convergent theological community.
- Vision explicitly emphasizes a Christ-centered education that instills knowledge and Truth.
- Public materials describe Classical Christian education as biblically grounded and Scripture-based.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed (from the Six Elements lists and the school's texts): Truth, God, Word of God, Christ-centered, glorify God, covenantal, sacred/scriptural grounding, theology, divine order.
- Negative keywords observed: None found in the public materials.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords observed approx. high (roughly 6–8 distinct, clearly Christian/theological terms cited across sources); Negative keywords observed approx. 0.
- Why this rating: The school explicitly grounds education in theology and transcendental, real norms (Truth, God, Christ, Word of God) and frames its formation around a sacred order. This aligns strongly with Transcendental Moral Realism and Grounded in Theology, with liturgical/community practice present through covenantal worship language and shared faith commitments.
- Rating justification
- CLASSICAL
- Supporting citations
- Mission and covenant language: Trinity Classical School materials (Three Points to Our Mission; Covenant commitments).
- Christ-centered, Scripture-grounded framing: Classical Christian education description and Christ-centered language.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission/purpose statements frame education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, not solely job preparation; emphasis on glorifying God and forming the whole person.
- Vision emphasizes a distinctly Christ-centered education that instills a passion for knowledge and Truth.
- Language about virtue, excellence, and leadership as aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: virtue, wisdom, truth, knowledge, formation, character, sanctified aims (glorify God), sacred/truth-centric framing.
- Negative keywords observed: none indicating neutral or utilitarian aims.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords observed approx. moderate to high (several key terms appear); Negative keywords observed approx. 0.
- Why this rating: The school consistently emphasizes formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth/beauty within a theocentric framework, aligning with classical aims beyond mere information transfer or job-readiness.
- Rating justification
- CLASSICAL
- Supporting citations
- Mission/Vision statements and aims: Mission: covenantal with Christian parents; Vision: Christ-centered education instills Truth.
- Glorify God and formation emphasis: Mission statements and covenantal language.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Explicit classical structure: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Senior Capstone; Latin I/II; upper-school rhetoric focus; Veritas Omnibus (as cited in curriculum materials).
- Lower School Curriculum includes Narration, Copywork, Dictation, Composer Study, Nature Study; emphasis on memory, language formation, and disciplined study.
- Upper School includes Logic and Rhetoric; Senior Capstone; Classical language offerings like Latin; cross-curricular emphasis on classical humanities and integrated study (e.g., Omnibus series).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, Rhetoric, Logic, Capstone, Great Books/Great Conversation (not always explicit text-based in school pages, but the classical canon framing appears via Omnibus and Veritas Press mentions), Narration, Copywork, Dictation, Nature Study, Classical/Humanities integration.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating anti-classical approach.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords observed approx. high (multiple explicit classical terms and practices); Negative keywords approx. 0.
- Why this rating: The curriculum embodies core classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric; liberal arts orientation; Great Books cadence via living texts and Omnibus; memory-centered pedagogy). This strongly supports CLASSICAL classification.
- Rating justification
- CLASSICAL
- Supporting citations
- Explicit curriculum elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin; capstone): Curricula and capability pages.
- Lower School memory-based pedagogy (Narration/Copywork/Dictation/Nature Study): Lower School Curriculum page.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Pedagogical approach includes lower-school memory- and recitation-based practices (Narration, Copywork, Dictation, Nature Study) and upper-school emphasis on logic and rhetoric, compatible with classical pedagogy.
- Emphasis on developing critical thinking through rhetoric in upper grades and a capstone experience (Senior Capstone).
- Memorable/experiential elements (Narration and Composer Study) align with formation through practice and memory (consistent with the classical model).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: Memory-based pedagogy, narration, copywork, dictation, composer study, nature study, rhetoric, logic, capstone, public-speaking opportunities.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating purely project-based or non-rehearsal-dominant methods without memory or core drill.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords observed approx. high; Negative keywords approx. 0.

- Why this rating: Pedagogy includes the essential memory-and-rhythm formation (Scholé-like elements) and Socratic/eloquence-oriented work (logic, rhetoric) that characterize classical teaching methods.
- Rating justification
- CLASSICAL
- Supporting citations
- Lower School Narration/Copywork/Dictation: Curriculum page.
- Upper School Logic/Rhetoric and Senior Capstone: Curriculum page.
- Mission/vision language about forming through Christian classical methods: Mission statements.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Faculty described as living curriculum and as mentors modeling virtue; public materials emphasize personal commitment to Christ and professional excellence.
- Staff/Faculty pages emphasize the role of faculty in forming students and the school's expectations about teacher virtues.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, virtue, professionalism, faith and reason, wisdom-centered teaching, mentorship, imitation of the good.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating a negative portrayal of faculty.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords observed approx. high; Negative keywords approx. 0.
- Why this rating: The school frames faculty as virtuous exemplars and the core conduit of the curriculum, aligning with Classical norms of teacher as exemplar and guide.
- Rating justification
- CLASSICAL
- Supporting citations
- "Living curriculum" and "faculty exemplify Christ" language: covenants and staff statements.
- Our Staff & Faculty page highlights individual faculty portraits and roles.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Strong covenantal language with Christian parents and the expectation that schools partner with families; admissions policy ties family faith to school membership.
- Parents' involvement framed as co-educators within a shared mission; communications emphasize parent-school partnership and family commitment.
- Giving and community activities (Walk of Faith, donor involvement) show a community-oriented culture that supports classical formation and shared mission.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, parent involvement, co-educators, family formation, parental engagement, covenantal commitment, walking in faith, community support.

- Negative keywords observed: None indicating exclusive reliance on staff without family involvement.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords observed approx. high; Negative keywords approx. 0.
- Why this rating: The school explicitly positions parents as essential partners and co-educators within a covenantal Christian framework, aligning with the classical emphasis on family formation and community.
- Rating justification
- CLASSICAL
- Supporting citations
- Covenant with Christian parents; parents as co-educators language: Mission/Admissions materials.
- Family formation and community engagement: Covenant language and Giving sections.

What Would Move the Needle

- Since the assessment across all six categories is CLASSICAL, there are no category-level needle-moving changes required to reach CLASSICAL consistency. No additional transitions are necessary at this time.
- If one intended to pursue a more robust alignment beyond CLASSICAL (or to address any marginal gaps that could be perceived by more academically strict classical norms), potential enhancements could include:
- Explicit articulation of Great Books and Great Conversation in public materials, with concrete examples of canonical texts and discussion formats.
- More explicit mention of Socratic dialogue/seminars in upper levels to align with 6th-category pedagogy expectations, while preserving the current memory-based lower-school approach.
- A formal “liturgical/communal practices” subsection detailing morning worship, chapel, or other structured communal reverence elements, to strengthen liturgical foundations per the rubrics.
- These are not required to maintain CLASSICAL status but could strengthen a potential “fully CLASSICAL” designation for readers who expect explicit, named practices in every sub-area.
- Supporting references (for needle-movement ideas, if desired): The Six Essential Elements document describes Great Books/Great Conversation, Socratic dialogue, and liturgical aspects as core, which could be foregrounded in future communications.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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